

Ἀριστόνικος ὁ Ταραντῖνος

Aristonicus of Tarentum on the Wanderings of Io

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Period: Ἑλληνιστική [Hellenistic](#)

Dialect: Κοινή [Koine](#)

Domain: Ἱστορία [History](#)

Format: Πεζός [Prose](#)

Aristonicus of Tarentum was a Greek author from Tarentum in southern Italy, active in the 4th or 3rd century BCE. A shadowy figure, no details of his personal life survive beyond his origin in that major Doric colony.

His sole known work is the lost treatise *On the Wanderings of Io*. Surviving fragments indicate it was a mythological-geographical text tracing the route of the mythical Io to explain place names like the Ionian Sea. The geographer Strabo quotes from it.

Aristonicus is significant as a source for later scholars. His work was consulted by the Homeric commentator Aristarchus of Samothrace, as noted in the scholia to the *Iliad*. His fragments represent the Hellenistic periegetic tradition, using myth to explicate geography and contributing to the scholarly study of Homeric references.

Works (1)

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